



TURNER

THEOLOGICAL SEMINARY

The Office of the President

May 15, 2026

Lilly Endowment Inc.
2801 N. Meridian St.
P.O. Box 88068
Indianapolis, Indiana 46208-0068

RE: Official Request Letter

Dear Lilly Endowment Review Committee:

Turner Theological Seminary respectfully submits this request for funding consideration for “The Turner Model: Expanding Christian Practices Through Four Pathways of Formation — Calling, Care, Community, and Renewal.”

This initiative responds to the increasing spiritual, emotional, and societal challenges facing congregations and ministry leaders. Through an integrated model of formation, Turner seeks to strengthen vocational leadership, pastoral wellness, community engagement, and sustainable ministry practices grounded in theological reflection and practical application.

Rooted in Turner’s historic mission and responsive to contemporary ministry realities, the initiative will cultivate leaders equipped to guide churches and communities through trauma, uncertainty, division, and transformation with resilience, care, and faith-centered leadership. As a historic theological institution within the African Methodist Episcopal tradition, Turner is uniquely positioned to expand adaptable models of Christian formation across diverse ministry contexts. Through strengthened partnerships, institutional growth, accreditation progress, and innovative formation initiatives, the Seminary is prepared to implement this work with measurable impact.

This proposal reflects Turner’s continued commitment to preparing transformative leaders for the Church and the communities it serves. We appreciate Lilly Endowment’s continued investment in theological education and Christian leadership formation and thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Ammie L. Davis, Ph.D.
President & CEO

Bishop Michael L. Mitchell
Chair, Board of Trustees

